

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS



A Very Merry *Murder*



A Cozy Christmas Murder Mystery Party Game

6-16 PLAYERS

90 MIN-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF



STOP.

HOST ONLY · DO NOT OPEN UNTIL THE REVEAL

Solution & Reveal



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

LETTER + A4 · 12 CHARACTER BOOKLETS

The solution



WHO DID IT

Robin Holly, the head toymaker, poisoned Nick with foxglove hidden in a homemade "peppermint syrup", given to him as a Secret Santa gift.

The clue chain: how players can prove it

- 1 The poison was in the syrup, not the eggnog.** (E1) (E2) (E3)
Nobody else who drank the eggnog fell ill (E2). Nick added the syrup to his own mug at 9:00 (Casey's statement; E3). Timing fits a 9:00 poisoning (E1). This clears **Casey**, who made the eggnog, and **Jordan**, who only carried the mug.
- 2 The syrup was Nick's Secret Santa gift, and Robin drew Nick.** (E3) (E7)
(E3, E7). Taylor saw someone in a green workshop apron put the red-ribboned box under the tree at 6:45.
- 3 Only Robin could get the foxglove.** (E5) (E6) (E8) (E11)
It was cut between 3:00 and 5:00 (E6). The only key logged out in that window was Robin's, 4:00 to 4:30 (E5). The gardener holds the other key but was in the village (receipt 4:20, E6). Morgan's visit was at 6:00, too late. Sam was on the train until 6:05 and Alex was in town until 6:50 (E11). Jordan was in the study with Nick from 3:00 to 5:00 (E8).
- 4 Robin made the syrup.** (E12)
Casey's saucepan and peppermint extract ended up in the workshop kitchenette, smelling of peppermint and bitter greens (E12). Casey says Robin borrowed them at 4:45.

5

Robin lied and got rid of the bottle. (E9) (E10)

The reindeer Robin "gave" Nick is still wrapped in Robin's drawer (E10). The poison bottle was thrown from the workshop window (E9), seen by Alex, heard by Riley, and confirmed by Robin's absence from Charlie's 9:50 photo.

6

Motive. (E8)

Robin's nutcracker sat outside the study door at 3:30 (E8), when Jordan heard someone listening. Robin learned that the workshop would close and that every design Robin ever made would belong to MegaMart.

Why the others didn't do it

SUSPECT	MOTIVE (RED HERRING)	CLEARED BY
Jordan Tinsel	Stole from the charity fund; Nick threatened police	In the study with Nick 3:00–5:00; never opened the mug
Sam Garland	Heir; in debt; poison notes in the cardigan pocket (E4)	On the train until 6:05; notes were novel research
Casey Sleigh	Unpaid \$4,000 bill	Eggnog was clean; saucepan was borrowed by Robin
Alex Snow	Stolen Snowflake Sled design	In town until 6:50; gifts were under the tree by then
Morgan Ivy	Being fired	Greenhouse visit at 6:00, after the foxglove was cut
Frankie Fir	Selling poinsettias	In the village 3:15–4:50 (receipt)
Taylor, Charlie, Quinn, Jamie, Riley	Smaller secrets	No greenhouse access and no link to the gift



Script 5: The reveal

"Nicholas Frost wasn't poisoned by the eggnog. Every one of us drank it. He was poisoned by a gift: a little bottle of peppermint syrup, made by someone who knew how much he loved peppermint.

That syrup was his Secret Santa present, and the Secret Santa list says Nick was drawn by **Robin Holly**. Robin, you told us you gave him a carved reindeer. But that reindeer is still wrapped in your workbench drawer.

The foxglove was cut between three and five o'clock. Only one name is on the key log in that window: yours, at four. You borrowed Casey's saucepan and peppermint extract at a quarter to five, and we found them in the workshop kitchenette. When Nick fell, you slipped away, opened the workshop window and threw the bottle into the snow. Alex saw a green apron at that window, Riley heard it open, and Charlie's photo shows you weren't with us.

And the reason? At half past three you stood outside Nick's study with a new toy in your hands, and you heard him sell your workshop, your Jingle Bear and fifteen years of your work to MegaMart, then call you a sentimental fool.

Robin Holly, you made toys to bring people joy. Tonight you made something else. Merry Christmas, everyone, and well done to our detectives."

Now ask Robin to take a bow, read out the ballots and hand out the awards.

Scoring & awards



Answer key for the ballots

QUESTION	POINTS	CORRECT ANSWER
Who?	3	Robin Holly
How?	1	Foxglove hidden in a homemade "peppermint syrup", given as a Secret Santa gift and poured into the eggnog at 9:00
Why?	1	Robin overheard the MegaMart sale: the workshop would close and every Robin design, the Jingle Bear included, would belong to MegaMart

Award procedure

1. Read Script 5 and let Robin take a bow.
2. Read each ballot aloud and add up the points.
3. **Best Detective:** the highest score. On a tie, the best "clue that convinced you" wins.
4. **Best Costume:** a vote by show of hands.
5. **Best Liar:** usually Robin, or put it to a vote.
6. Fill in the certificates from 34-Awards-and-Table-Signs.pdf and take a group photo.